

Hosting Guide

CRM/ERP Platform Documentation

Hosting Guide

Comparison of hosting options for the CRM platform.

Option 1: Railway + Netlify (Recommended)

Best for: Teams wanting managed infrastructure with minimal ops overhead.

Service	What	Cost
Railway	Backend NestJS app	~\$5–20/mo (usage-based)
Railway MySQL	Database	~\$5–10/mo
Railway Redis	Job queues	~\$5/mo
Netlify	Frontend Next.js	Free tier → \$19/mo

Pros: Zero server management, auto-deploys from Git, built-in SSL, easy env var management.

Cons: Railway is usage-based — spiky traffic can be expensive. Netlify requires a plugin for Next.js server components.

Steps: See [Deployment.md](#) → Railway + Netlify sections.

Option 2: VPS (Ubuntu)

Best for: Cost-sensitive deployments with predictable traffic. Full control.

Recommended VPS providers

- Hetzner Cloud (CX21 = 2 vCPU, 4 GB RAM, €3.79/mo)
- DigitalOcean Droplet (2 vCPU, 2 GB RAM, \$18/mo)
- Linode/Akamai

Server setup

```
# 1. Install Node.js 20
curl -fsSL https://deb.nodesource.com/setup_20.x | sudo -E bash -
sudo apt-get install -y nodejs

# 2. Install MySQL 8
sudo apt install mysql-server -y
sudo mysql_secure_installation

# 3. Install Redis
sudo apt install redis-server -y
sudo systemctl enable redis

# 4. Install PM2 (process manager)
npm install -g pm2

# 5. Clone and build
git clone <repo> /var/www/crm
cd /var/www/crm/backend && npm ci && npx prisma migrate deploy && npm run build
cd /var/www/crm/mycrm && npm ci && npm run build

# 6. Start with PM2
pm2 start /var/www/crm/backend/dist/main.js --name crm-backend
pm2 start /var/www/crm/mycrm/node_modules/.bin/next --name crm-frontend -- start -p 3000
pm2 save && pm2 startup

# 7. Nginx reverse proxy
sudo apt install nginx -y
```

Nginx config

```
# /etc/nginx/sites-available/crm
server {
    listen 80;
```

```
server_name app.yourdomain.com;

# Frontend
location / {
    proxy_pass http://localhost:3000;
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
}

# Backend API (or handle proxy in Next.js)
location /api/v1/ {
    proxy_pass http://localhost:4000/api/v1/;
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade;
    proxy_set_header Connection "upgrade";
    client_max_body_size 15M;
}
}
```

```
sudo ln -s /etc/nginx/sites-available/crm /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/
sudo certbot --nginx -d app.yourdomain.com # free SSL
sudo systemctl reload nginx
```

Option 3: Docker Compose

Best for: Reproducible environments; easy team onboarding.

See the `docker-compose.yml` in [Deployment.md](#).

For production, add:

- A named volume for `backend/uploads/` to persist files across deployments
 - Health checks on the db service
 - A deploy script that runs `prisma migrate deploy` before starting the backend
-

Option 4: XAMPP (Local / Intranet Only)

Best for: Small office deployments on a Windows machine accessible over LAN.

1. Install XAMPP and start Apache + MySQL
2. Create the database in phpMyAdmin
3. Run the backend and frontend with `npm run start:dev` / `npm run dev`
4. Other machines on the LAN access via `http://<host-ip>:3000`

Update `backend/.env` :

```
FRONTEND_URL=http://192.168.1.55:3000,http://localhost:3000
```

This is not recommended for internet-facing deployments — no SSL, no process manager.

File Storage

The backend stores uploaded files in `backend/uploads/{orgId}/{filename}`.

For production, this directory must be:

- **Persistent:** If using containers, mount a volume.
- **Backed up:** See [Backup-Recovery.md](#).
- **Writable:** Ensure the process user has write permission.

For high-availability setups, replace local storage with S3-compatible object storage (a code change is required to swap `multer` disk storage for S3 streaming).

Minimum Hardware Requirements

Tier	CPU	RAM	Storage	Use case
Small	1 vCPU	1 GB	20 GB	<10 users, dev
Medium	2 vCPU	4 GB	50 GB	<100 users
Large	4 vCPU	8 GB	200 GB	<1000 users